


VER. 26.1

# Authenticity

## Gauntlets

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# 1. Implementation

The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 09.11.2024.
The document and its rules have been implemented since the 2025 season.

# 2. Definition

"**Gauntlets (a pair of)**" is the term used to describe all hand protections.

Type of Gauntlets:

- **Scales gauntlets**
  Gauntlets made of multiple metal scales.
- **Hourglass gauntlets**
  Named after an hourglass due to its shape. They are the main Gauntlets used during the 14th to the 16th century. Historically they have separated fingers.
- **Segmented mittens**
  Gauntlets that appeared in the late 14th century. They are made of articulated plates. Historical sources are quite few and controversial.
- **3/4 gauntlets**
  Gauntlets that appeared in the early 15th century. They combine strength and flexibility due to separated fingers.
- **Milaneses gauntlets**
  Gauntlets that appeared in the middle of the 15th century. They are articulated and provide very good protection.
- **Late 15th century gauntlets**
  Bifurcated mittens from the late 15th century. They follow the same shape as milanese or gothic-style mittens, but the fingers are separated in the middle.
- **Plate articulated mittens**
  Gauntlets that appeared in the late 15th century. They are made of articulated plates.
- **Under-shield gauntlets**
  Metal plates riveted to a fabric base. They are allowed as buhurt-optimization. They must be worn only with a shield.
- **Eastern gauntlets**
  Due to very few historical sources, it is allowed to use eastern stylization of European Gauntlets. Allowed designs are displayed in the "*Eastern Armors*" document.

# 3. General Requirements

## 3.1. Historical Basis

All Gauntlets must be based on historical sources.

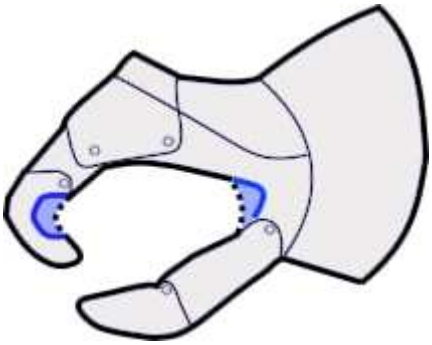
## 3.2. Proportional Accuracy

The proportions of the Gauntlets must replicate those found in historical sources.

## 3.3. Aesthetic Consistency

The overall aesthetic of the Gauntlets must imitate that of historical sources.
It is allowed to adapt the historical designs to allow a better grip. Such adapted design must conform with the historical design and proportions.

Example of approved adapted design for better grip:



## 3.4. Component Proportions

Components must not be out of proportion in terms of length, size, or curve.
Components must fit harmoniously with one another, and the gauntlet must function properly.

## 3.5. Comprehensive Protection

Gauntlets must protect the entire hand, including the wrist, fingers, and nails.

## 3.6. Metal Components

Any metal parts of the Gauntlet must conform to the standards outlined in the *“Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations”* document.

## 3.7. Textile and Leather Components

Any textile or leather parts of the Gauntlet must adhere to the standards outlined in the *“Textiles and Leather”* document.

## 3.8. Decorative Elements

Gauntlets may be decorated in medieval styles, such as etching, engraving, plating, or gilding.
Decoration must be consistent with historical sources and the overall armor style.

## 3.9. Prohibited Imagery

The use of modern and/or offensive imagery and slogans is strictly prohibited.

# 4. Scales Gauntlets

## 4.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Scales Gauntlets are made of several scales sewn or riveted to a base, made of fabric or leather.
They are based on historical sources of the first half of the **14th century.**
They are **Approved** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors.**
They are **Denied** for **15th century armors.**



*BNF Français 2091 Vita et Passio Beati Dionysii - 1317 - France*



*Bodley 264 Romance of Alexander - 1338/1344 - England*

## 4.2. Specific Requirements

Scales Gauntlets must:

- conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above),
- be made of square or rectangular metal plates,
- be made of:
  - 5 rows of scales to protect the hand and the fingers,
  - 3 rows of scales to protect the sleeve and the wrist,
- have a pronounced curve at the wrist.

## 4.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions





*Pictures from Ficelle ©*

## 4.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

**Not enough scales** (1 row on the wrist)





*Pictures from The Medieval Things ©*

# 5. Hourglass Gauntlets

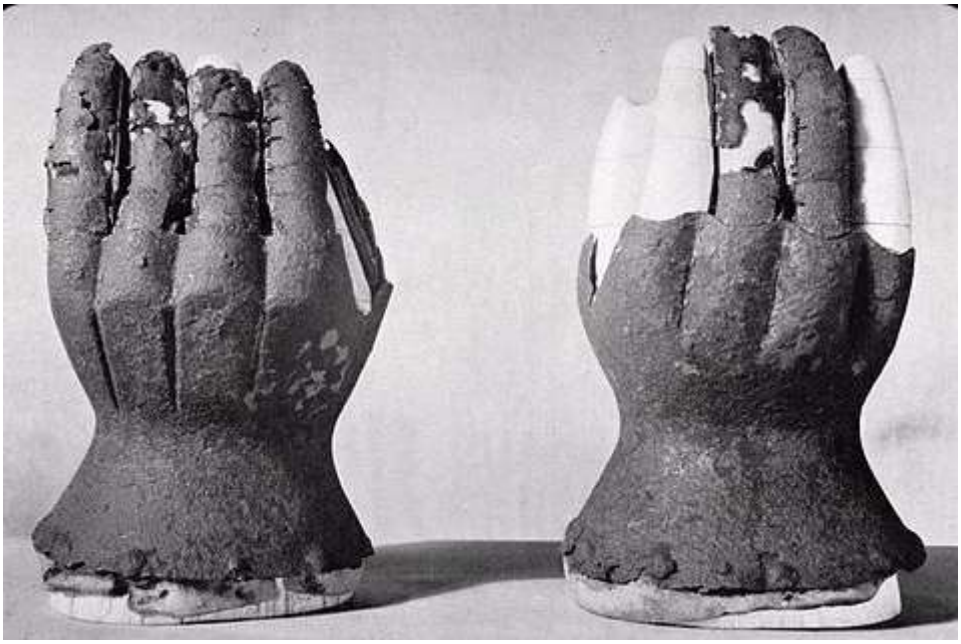
## 5.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Hourglass Gauntlets appeared around the middle of the 14th century. They were still in use during the 15th century under different designs. They are made of a solid cuff, designed as an hourglass, and separated finger plates.

For safety reasons, it is allowed to use a buhurt-optimization version of hourglass Gauntlets, with non-separated finger plates (also called “Hourglass mittens”). This type of Gauntlet must respect the style of historical hourglass gauntlets and be properly articulated.

The historical Gauntlets with separated fingers lack safety. They are no longer allowed in Buhurt International.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.



*Gauntlets of Ripon Cathedral - 1380/1410 - England*

## 5.2. Specific Requirements

Hourglass Gauntlets must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

The design of the cuff must clearly present the correct hourglass shape.

Thumb protection must:

- have anatomical shape,
- be articulated with at least 2 segments, or
- imitate the appearance of 2 segments-articulated thumb.

Despite being 100% historical, separated-fingers Gauntlets are **not allowed** due to lack of safety.

## 5.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



*Picture from Medieval Extreme ©*



*Picture from Master Uley ©*

## 5.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

**Fully articulated fingers**



*Picture from Age of Craft ©*

**Plate Gauntlets with brigandine cuffs**

Historical sources do not support this construction. Brigandine gauntlets were built with small plates of metal riveted to a leather base, which makes them not safe enough for our sport.



*Picture from The Medieval Things ©*

# 6. Segmented Mittens

## 6.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Segmented mittens are based on controversial historical sources. One of them in a wooden statue decorating a fountain in Nuremberg (Germany). The actual statue is a reproduction of the original one. One of its hands is incomplete so it's not possible to evaluate the accuracy of this source.

For safety reasons, it is allowed to use buhurt-optimized segmented mittens with alternative design. This type of Gauntlets must respect the style of historical segmented mittens and be properly articulated.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.





*Fountain of Nuremberg (Germany), the original is from the 14th century (left) and the reproduction is from the 20th century (right).*

## 6.2. Specific Requirements

Segmented mittens must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

The design of the cuff must clearly present the correct hourglass shape.

Thumb protection must:

- have anatomical shape,
- be articulated with at least 2 segments, or
- imitate the appearance of 2 segments-articulated thumb.

## 6.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



*Picture from Age of Craft ©*

# 7. 3/4 Gauntlets

## 7.1. Historical Sources and Datation

3/4 gauntlets tend to appear in the early 15th century. They are made of a solid cuff with a metacarpal plate. This plate can be riveted or articulated. Fingers are protected by separated plates or chainmail.

They are **Approved** for **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

They are **Denied** for **14th century armors**.

**For safety reasons, 3/4 gauntlets must use faux-finger mittens rather than individual finger plates.** In other words, separate, fully articulated finger gauntlets are **not permitted**. These **mitten-style** 3/4 gauntlets must still respect the overall historical shape and proper articulation of 15th-century examples.



*Churchburg- 1410/1430 - Italy*



*Sion Castle Museum - 1420/1440 - Switzerland*

## 7.2. Specific Requirements

3/4 *Gauntlets* must conform to the General Requirements(see Section 3 above).

The design of the cuff must clearly present the correct hourglass shape.

Metacarpal plate can be either riveted or historically accurate articulation

Thumb protection must:

- have anatomical shape,
- be articulated with at least 2 segments, or
- imitate the appearance of 2 segments-articulated thumb.

## 7.3. Examples of Denied Reproductions

**Fully articulated fingers**



*Picture from Age of Craft ©*

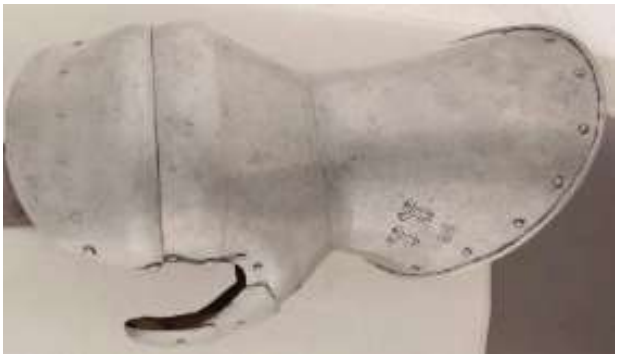
# 8. Milanese Gauntlets

## 8.1. Historical Sources and Datation

“Milanese gauntlets” term regroups several 15th century mitten shapes, with different designs. Common features are articulated plates (including metacarpal plate, such as 3/4 gauntlets), profiled wrist plate and a full protection of the fingers.

They are **Approved** for **15th century armors.**

They are **Denied** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors.**



*Glasgow - 1438/1440 - Scotland*



*Metropolitan Museum of Art - 1450/1470*

## 8.2. Specific Requirements

Milanese Gauntlets must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

The design of the cuff must clearly present the correct profiled shape.

The cuff must match the historical proportion in matter of length and width.

Cuff and metacarpal plate can be either riveted or historically accurate articulation

Thumb protection must:

- have anatomical shape,
- be articulated with at least 2 segments, or
- imitate the appearance of 2 segments-articulated thumb.

## 8.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions





*Pictures from Black Dog Armoury ©*

# 9. Late 15th century Gauntlets

## 9.1. Historical Sources and Datation

The term “Late 15th century Gauntlets” regroups 2 different types of Gauntlets: bifurcated mittens and locked Gauntlets.

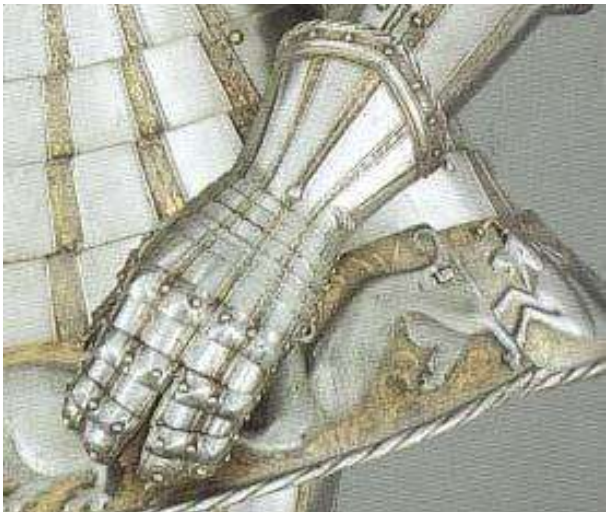
They are **Approved** for **15th century armors**.

They are **Denied** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors**.

## 9.2. Bifurcated Mittens

They follow the same shape as milanese mittens, but the fingers are protected by 2 plates instead of 1, increasing the handling of the weapon. They appeared in the late 15th century.





## 9.3. Locked Gauntlets

They follow the same shape as milanese mittens, but the whole *Gauntlet* can be locked to prevent any weapon loss.



## 9.4. Specific Requirements

Late 15th Century Gauntlets must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

The design of the cuff must clearly present the correct profiled shape.

The cuff must match the historical proportion in matter of length and width.

Cuff and metacarpal plate can be either riveted or historically accurate articulation

Thumb protection must:

- have anatomical shape,
- be articulated with at least 2 segments, or
- imitate the appearance of 2 segments-articulated thumb.

# 10. Plate Articulated Mittens

## 10.1. Historical Sources and Datation

There are no historical sources for such Gauntlets. They are buhurt-optimization Gauntlets designed to provide sufficient protection for full contact fights.

The global design takes inspiration from the photo below (1510 gauntlet).

They are **Approved** for **14th century, Transitional** and **15th century armors**.



*Wallace Collection - Germany*

## 10.2. Specific Requirements

Plate articulated mittens must conform to the General Requirements (see section 3 above).

The design of the cuff must clearly present the correct profiled shape.

The cuff must match the historical proportion in matter of length and width.

Cuff and metacarpal plate can be either riveted or historically accurate articulation

Thumb protection must:

- have anatomical shape,
- be articulated with at least 2 segments, or
- imitate the appearance of 2 segments-articulated thumb.

## 10.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions






*Pictures from Medieval Extreme ©*

# 11. Under-shield Gauntlets

## 11.1. Historical sources and datation

There are no historical sources for such Gauntlets. They are buhurt-optimized Gauntlets designed to provide sufficient protection for the shield-wearer, thus being lighter and cheaper. However, it is not recommended to use such under-shield Gauntlets for buhurt categories.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

## 11.2. Specific Requirements

Under-shield Gauntlets must:

- conform to the general requirements (see section 3 above),
- be made of metal plates riveted or sewn to a fabric or leather base.

The plates:

- Must cover at least the fingers, including the thumb and the exposed-part of the wrist.
- Must be firmly-riveted to a fabric or leather base

The base must conform to the *"Textiles and Leather"* document.

## 11.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions




*Pictures from Medieval Extreme*

## 11.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

**<u>No metal plate to protect the fingers</u>**



*Pictures from The Medieval Things ©*

# 12. Buhurt-optimization locking systems

## 12.1. Historical Sources and Datation

There are no historical sources for locking systems. However, it is likely plausible that knights of the middle ages used different techniques to prevent any loss of weapon during the battle. One of them consists of chains attached to the coat of plate. If the weapon should slip from the hand, it will not touch the ground, and therefore can be grabbed back.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

Buhurt-optimization system can be:

- A system to attach the weapon to the Gauntlet, preventing any loss of weapon,
- A system to lock the Gauntlet in “close” position, preventing any loss of weapon,
- A system to attach the Gauntlet to the forearm, preventing the Gauntlet to be removed.

## 12.2. Specific Requirements

Buhurt-optimization locking system can be allowed under certain conditions.

- **Weapon lock**
  It is allowed to lock a weapon to the Gauntlet with an additional leather thread, leather strap, or any discrete and historically plausible system.
  Additional leather elements must conform to the *“Textiles and Leather”* document.

- **Locked gauntlets**
  It is allowed to lock a Gauntlet in “close” position with an additional leather strap, or any discrete and historically plausible system.
  Additional leather elements must conform to the *“Textiles and Leather”* document.

- **Gauntlet’s safeguard**
  It is allowed to attach a Gauntlet to another armor element (I.E forearm, gambeson) with an additional leather thread, leather strap, or any discrete and historically plausible system.
  Additional leather elements must conform to the *“Textiles and Leather”* document.

## 12.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions

**Lace or strap to secure the Gauntlet in close position**



*Picture from Medieval Extreme ©*



*Picture from F. Guts ©*

## 12.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

**Strap is too visible**



# 13. Other Denied Items

**Chainmail Gauntlet, not safe enough**



**Brigant Gauntlets are not safe enough**



***Gauntlets* not based on historical sources**





*Pictures from The Medieval Things ©*

# 14. Changelog

This will be the change log of this document. It will be updated regularly and we will display what has been removed/added/reworded/formatted. This way we keep transparent communication and clarity about the rules

**January - 2026 (V. 26.1)**
Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Add: “1. Implementation” (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
Clarification:
- Modification of “1. Definition and general requirements” to “1. Definition”
Replace:
- “2.1 Definition” by “Type of gauntlets:”
Add:
- In 3.3 Aesthetic Consistency: “It is allowed to adapt the historical designs to allow a better grip. Such adapted design must conform with the historical design and proportions.” and a picture as an example
- In 4.4 Examples of denied reproductions (scales gauntlets): “(1 row on the wrist)”
- In 5.4 Examples of denied reproductions (hourglass gauntlets): “Fully articulated fingers”
Replace:
- In 5.4 Examples of denied reproductions (hourglass gauntlets): “The leather part is not based on historical sources.” by “Plate gauntlets with brigandine cuffs are not based on historical sources”
- In 7. ¾ gauntlets: paragraph “For safety reasons, [...]” entirely rewritten
Add:
- In 7.4 Examples of denied reproductions (¾ gauntlets): “Fully articulated fingers”
Replace:
- In 8.1 Historical sources and datation (Milanese gauntlets):
- “They are approved for Transitional and 15th century armors.” by “They are approved for 15th century armors.”
- “They are denied for 14th century armors.” by “They are denied for 14th century and Transitional armors.”
Add:
- In 13.4 Examples of approved reproductions (Buhurt-optimization locking systems): new picture from F. Guts ©

**05-Dec-2024**: -add
Document has been created (Version 2024.12)